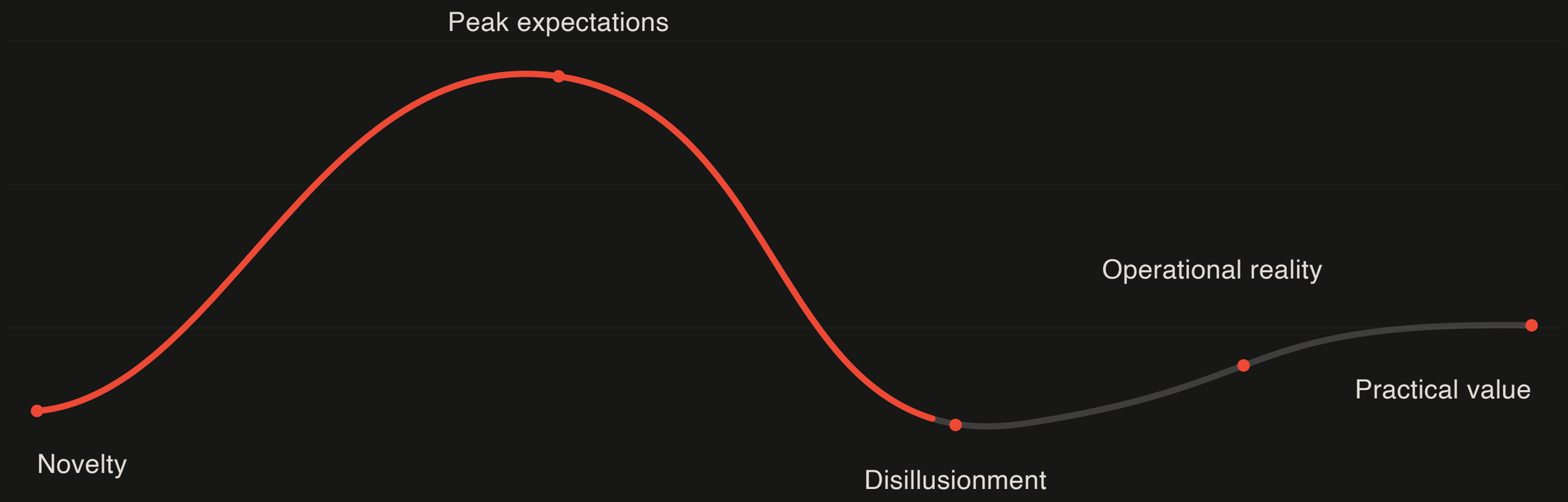
BRINGING AI INTO YOUR ORGANIZATION

AI adoption as an operating-model problem.

DUSTIN UPDYKE
CMU SOFTWARE ENGINEERING INSTITUTE
12 NOVEMBER 2026

FROM HYPE TO REALITY.




EVERYONE
HAS A
TAKE.

✓ ACCESS ✓ DEMOS ! CONTROLS ? STRATEGY

THE MODEL IS NOT THE BOTTLENECK.

Changing behavior is hard.

LAYERS OF CHANGE.



01

THE ORG.

AI HAS THREE GATES.

01

ADOPTION

02

CAPACITY

03

INNOVATION


ADOPTION
THEATER.

TUESDAY AFTERNOON.





DO YOU BELIEVE?

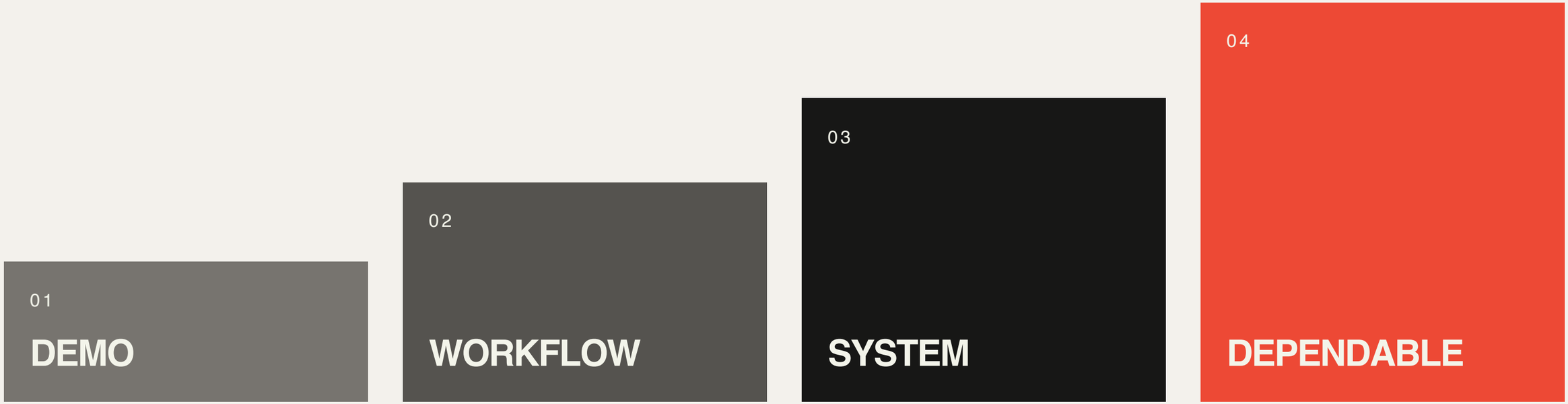
FROM DATA
TO CHANGED WORK.

DISCOVER	BELIEVE	DECIDE	ACT	REBUILD



GATE 2:
OVER
AND OVER
AND OVER
AGAIN

FROM DEMO TO CAPABILITY.





GATE 3:

ADOPTION: FASTER REPORT

CAPACITY: AUTOMATED REPORT

INNOVATION: WHY THIS REPORT?

WHY?

02

THE TEAM.

OUTPUT EXPLODES.

CODE	WRITING	ANALYSIS
IDEAS	MESSAGES	ARTIFACTS

FINITE ATTENTION.

MORE INFORMATION
≠ MORE COORDINATION.



CULTURE EATS STRATEGY EATS EVERYTHING ELSE

03

THE INDIVIDUAL.


WHAT IS
VALUABLE
WORK NOW?

THE HUMAN ADVANTAGE.

01

CRAFT

02

TASTE

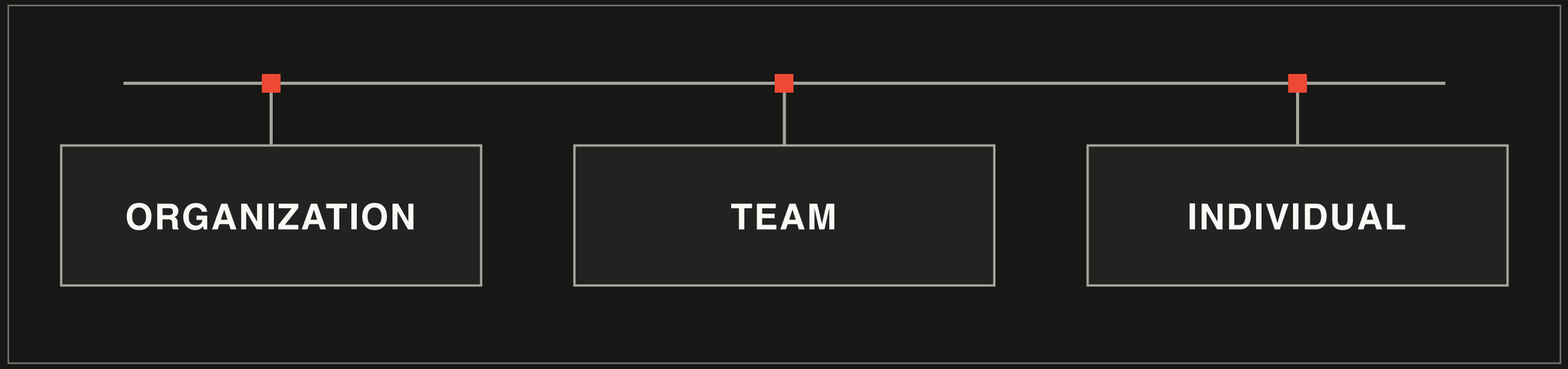
03

JUDGMENT

04

PURPOSE

THE OPERATING MODEL.



ON MONDAY, ASK THIS.

WHERE IS YOUR BOTTLENECK NOW?

GATES CAPACITY COORDINATION AUTHORITY TASTE

WHAT KIND OF ORGANIZATION WILL YOU BECOME?

THANK YOU.